SHEFFIELD SHIELD
Post-Match Tactical Review

SOUTH AUSTRALIA	VS	QUEENSLAND
Home Side		Away Side

📅 DATE	📍 VENUE	🏆 RESULT
20–23 October 2024	Allan Border Field, Brisbane	SA won by 129 runs

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Executive Summary

314	185	352/9	229
SA 1st Innings	QLD 1st Innings	SA 2nd Innings	QLD Target Chase

South Australia defeated Queensland by 129 runs, setting a fourth-innings target of 359. The match was shaped by two decisive individual interventions — Alex Carey's unbeaten 123 in the third innings, and Nathan McAndrew's pressure-driven bowling spell in the fourth — which together created and capitalised on scoreboard pressure to separate the sides.

FIRST INNINGS — SA BAT

South Australia established early control through a **106-run opening partnership**, with Henry Hunt anchoring the innings with a composed 136. However, a disciplined late spell from T. Whitney curtailed acceleration and restricted the total to 314, preventing what could have been a more decisive first-innings advantage.

FIRST INNINGS — QLD REPLY

Queensland's reply began under immediate pressure, **losing 3 wickets for just 16 runs** following a brilliant opening spell from Nathan McAndrew. Despite the early setback, Ben McDermott (52) and Jimmy Peirson (94) stabilised the middle order with substantial partnerships. Late-phase acceleration — at 5.09 runs per over in overs 51 and beyond — ensured Queensland remained competitive heading into the second innings.

THIRD INNINGS — THE TURNING POINT

Alex Carey's knock was the match's defining contribution. Entering the crease at 133/4 with SA's second innings under pressure, he produced an unbeaten **123 from 166 balls**, contributing 36% of the team's total runs and extending the innings to 352/9. His innings transformed a moderate lead into a demanding fourth-innings target.

FOURTH INNINGS — THE CHASE

Queensland began the chase promisingly at 61/0, but the match shifted dramatically in the middle phase. Rising dot-ball pressure stalled scoring momentum, and **McAndrew's decisive 7-over spell** triggered a collapse from **61/0 to 89/4**. Queensland never recovered the initiative, eventually bowled out for 229.

> *The outcome was decided by two key interventions: Carey's third-innings knock built the target, and McAndrew's fourth-innings spell exploited it. Together they created the 129-run margin of victory.*

Phase Analysis

Run Rate by Phase

The chart below tracks the run rate across each phase of all four innings. South Australia played conservatively in the first 20 overs before accelerating through the middle and late phases of their batting innings. Queensland's second innings showed the strongest late-phase acceleration of the match, indicating clear attacking intent as the ball aged. In their fourth-innings chase, however, Queensland's run rate remained flat across all phases — a critical failure to generate the momentum needed to chase a competitive target.

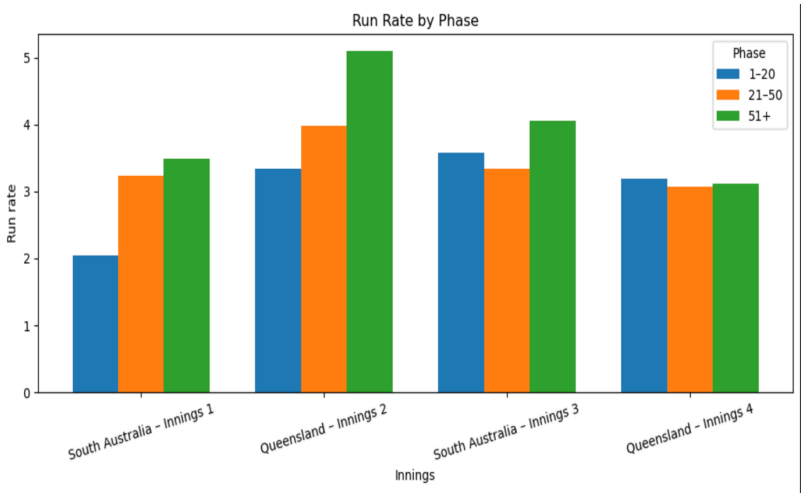

Figure 1 — Run rate by phase across all four innings

Dot Ball Percentage by Phase

Dot-ball percentage provides a sharper lens on scoring pressure than run rate alone. South Australia's first 20 overs in both innings showed a dot percentage consistently above 78%, reflecting a deliberate platform-building approach. Queensland's second innings demonstrated a clear release of pressure after the 50-over mark, with dot percentage dropping to approximately 60%. In the fourth innings, however, dot-ball pressure was persistent across all phases for Queensland — a key constraint that prevented any sustained scoring run and ultimately proved decisive in the match result.

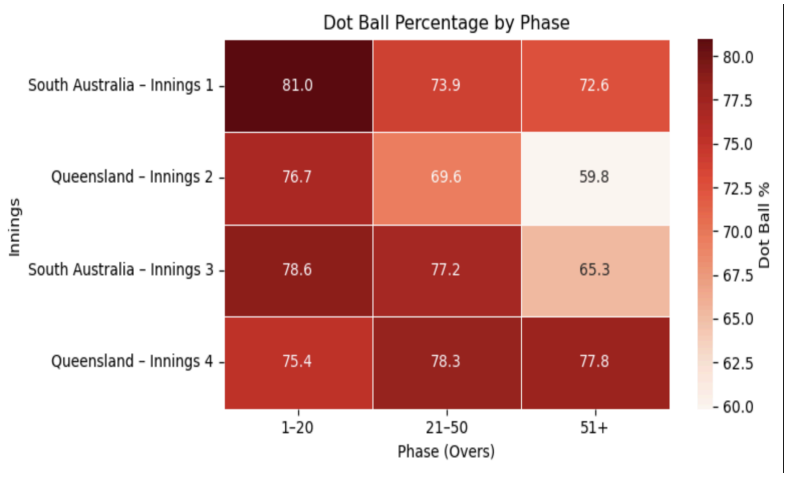

Figure 2 — Dot ball percentage by phase across all four innings

Spell Impact Analysis

Bowling spells were defined as continuous overs bowled by the same bowler, separated by at least one over from another bowler. Each spell was ranked using a composite impact score designed to reward wicket-taking while accounting for scoring suppression and sustained pressure.

> *Impact Score = (Wickets × 2) − Economy Rate + (Dot % × 2)*

Top 3 Highest-Impact Spells of the Match

innings	bowler	spell_id	start_over	end_over	overs	runs	wickets	balls	dot_pct	economy	impact_score	batting_team
4	N McAndrew	2	18	30	7	19	3.0	42	85.71%	2.71	5.00	Queensland
1	T Whitney	4	87	99	7	19	3.0	42	78.57%	2.71	4.85	South Australia
2	N McAndrew	1	1	11	6	13	2.0	36	86.11%	2.16	3.55	Queensland

Table 1 — Top 3 ranked bowling spells by impact score

McAndrew's Match-Defining Spell

Nathan McAndrew's fourth-innings spell was the single most impactful bowling performance of the match. When he was introduced, Queensland were cruising at 61/0, well-positioned for a competitive pursuit of the 359 target. Over 7 overs, he conceded just 19 runs, took 3 wickets, and maintained an economy rate of 2.71 — dismantling the Queensland top order and triggering a collapse to 89/4.

MATCHUP BREAKDOWN — MCANDREW VS QLD BATTERS

batter	balls	runs	dots	boundaries	singles	wickets	dot_pct	boundary_pct	single_pct
M Labuschagne	20	10	17	2	0	1.0	0.850000	0.100000	0.000000
LD Hearne	14	8	12	2	0	0.0	0.857143	0.142857	0.000000
J Clayton	3	1	2	0	1	0.0	0.666667	0.000000	0.333333
MT Renshaw	3	0	3	0	0	1.0	1.000000	0.000000	0.000000
BR McDermott	2	0	2	0	0	1.0	1.000000	0.000000	0.000000

Table 2 — McAndrew matchup data during his 4th innings spell

The matchup data reveals just how effectively McAndrew neutralised the Queensland top order:

- Marnus Labuschagne faced 20 balls at a dot rate of 85%, scoring only 10 runs before his dismissal — a significant psychological blow given his status as Queensland's most experienced batter.
- Both Renshaw and McDermott were dismissed early and could not establish a foothold against McAndrew's bowling.
- Strike rotation during the spell was severely limited, compounding the psychological pressure created by regular wicket-taking.

> *At 61/0, Queensland needed approximately 5.8 runs per over. The shift to 89/4 in just 7 overs meant the remaining batters faced a steeper required rate with fewer resources — a pressure dynamic from which Queensland never recovered.*

Batting Impact Analysis

While bowling intervention defined the fourth innings, South Australia's match advantage was constructed through significant batting contributions across the earlier innings. Each batting performance was assessed using a composite framework that incorporates four factors: proportion of team runs scored, runs accumulated during collapse phases (defined as three wickets falling within 15 balls), partnership contribution, and dot-ball control. This structure isolates innings that genuinely influenced match structure, rather than simply rewarding volume scoring.

Top 5 Highest-Impact Innings

Innings	batting_team	batter	runs	balls	strike_rate	dot %	team_run %	runs_in_collapse	max_partnership_runs	impact_score
3	South Australia	AT Carey	123	166	74.09	62.65%	36.17%	8.0	40	0.67
1	South Australia	HJ Hunt	136	314	43.31	77.70%	44.15%	1.0	54	0.56
2	Queensland	BR McDermott	52	99	52.52	74.74%	18.43%	11.0	33	0.54
4	Queensland	J Clayton	91	164	55.48	73.78%	40.80%	0.0	57	0.52
2	Queensland	JJ Peirson	94	119	78.99	60.50%	33.33%	0.0	55	0.47

Table 3 — Top 5 batting innings by impact score

Alex Carey — 123* (166) — 3rd Innings

Carey's innings was the most structurally significant batting contribution of the match. Entering at 133/4 with the innings in a vulnerable phase, he anchored a rebuilding effort and remained unbeaten until 352/9 — carrying the innings almost single-handedly through its most challenging passage. His 36% share of team runs in a nine-wicket scenario is an exceptional measure of individual impact, not just volume.

CAREY VS QLD BOWLERS — MATCHUP DETAIL

bowler	balls	runs	dots	boundaries	singles	wickets	dot_pct	boundary_pct	single_pct
MT Steketee	49	48	33	8	6	0.0	67.34%	16.32%	12.24%
MJ Swepson	44	23	30	2	11	0.0	68.18%	4.54%	25%
M Labuschagne	30	23	19	4	7	0.0	63.33%	13.33%	23.33%
MG Neser	21	11	13	1	7	0.0	61.90%	4.76%	33.33%
MT Renshaw	12	7	5	0	7	0.0	41.66%	0%	58.33%
T Whitney	10	15	4	3	3	0.0	40%	30%	30%

Table 4 — Carey matchup data across the 3rd innings

The matchup profile reveals sophisticated, adaptive batting rather than uniform aggression:

- Against Swepson (44 balls), Carey prioritised control and strike rotation — 11 singles, only 2 boundaries — indicating calculated risk management against the spinner and a deliberate refusal to take on the turning ball.
- Against Steketee (49 balls), the approach shifted: 8 boundaries suggests comfort and confidence against pace once set, exploiting length rather than spin.
- His acceleration against Whitney — 15 runs from 10 balls including 3 boundaries — indicates that he specifically identified Whitney as the weakest matchup and targeted him accordingly.

> *Carey demonstrated elite matchup awareness — absorbing pressure against control bowlers and expanding his scoring selectively against favourable matchups. This is a hallmark of a match-defining innings.*

Henry Hunt — 136 — 1st Innings

Hunt's first-innings 136 provided the foundational platform from which South Australia built their lead. As part of a 106-run opening partnership, his innings established early dominance and dictated the psychological terms of the match from the outset. Unlike Carey's innings, Hunt's contribution was defined by resilience and accumulation rather than aggression.

HUNT VS QLD BOWLERS — MATCHUP DETAIL

bowler	balls	runs	dots	boundaries	singles	wickets	dot_pct	boundary_pct	single_pct
MG Neser	79	26	64	2	8	1.0	81.01%	2.53%	10.12%
T Whitney	66	29	54	4	4	0.0	81.81%	6.06%	6.06%
MJ Swepson	60	31	45	4	9	0.0	75%	6.67%	15%
MT Steketee	59	31	47	5	4	0.0	79.61%	8.47%	6.79%
M Labuschagne	37	12	28	0	7	0.0	75.67%	0%	18.91%
MT Renshaw	7	5	3	0	3	0.0	42.85%	0%	42.85%
J Clayton	6	3	3	0	3	0.0	50%	0%	50%

Table 5 — Hunt matchup data across the 1st innings

The matchup data underscores the platform-building nature of his knock:

- Against Neser (79 balls) and Whitney (66 balls), Hunt absorbed sustained dot-ball pressure above 80% from both bowlers without resorting to high-risk shots. Boundary percentage remained below 6% in these matchups.
- Rather than targeting a specific bowler, Hunt demonstrated consistent matchup neutrality — maintaining control and composure across the attack without conceding any bowler a psychological advantage.
- His role was to build a platform and set the tone. In that context, the innings was a complete tactical success, even if it lacked the strike-rate profile of Carey's later knock.

— End of Report —